

Lesson 24: Passive Voice (is done, was done)

Introduction to Passive Voice in IT Context

"Hello, welcome to our lesson today. We will focus on understanding the passive voice, particularly the forms 'is done' and 'was done,' and their applications in IT. The passive voice is used when the focus is on the action rather than who performs it.

'Is done' is the present passive form, used to describe actions that are currently being completed. For instance, 'The software is updated regularly.' It emphasizes the action of updating the software.

'Was done' is the past passive form, used to describe actions that were completed in the past. For example, 'The system was checked for errors yesterday.' It highlights the action of checking the system, not who did it.

In IT, where processes and results are often more important than who performed the task, how do you typically describe actions or processes? Do you find using the passive voice helps in focusing on the results rather than the individuals?"

Different Ways to Use Passive Voice in IT

"Using 'Is Done' for Present Actions:

1. ****For Ongoing Processes****: 'The data is being analyzed by the software.' It indicates that the action is currently happening.

2. ****For General Statements****: 'Security protocols are followed in the company.' It describes a habitual action without specifying the doer.

Using 'Was Done' for Past Actions:

1. ****For Completed Actions****: 'The server was repaired last night.' It focuses on the action of repairing, not who repaired it.
2. ****For Reporting Past Events****: 'A new feature was added in the last update.' It informs about what happened, not necessarily who did it.

In your day-to-day IT operations, how do you decide when to use the passive voice? Do you find it more effective for focusing on actions rather than the actors?"

Dialogue between IT Professionals

"Let's see a dialogue between two IT professionals, Mike and Sara, using the passive voice:

***Mike**:* Sara, the server was crashed by a sudden power outage. Has it been fixed?

***Sara**:* Yes, it was repaired this morning. Currently, the data is being restored.

***Mike**:* Great. Also, I heard that a new security protocol is being implemented. Is that true?

***Sara**:* Yes, it is. It was decided after the last security breach. The software updates are done automatically now.

***Mike**:* I see. Was the network analysis completed?

***Sara**:* Yes, it was completed yesterday. The results are being reviewed by the team now.

*****Mike**:** Perfect. It's good to know that these tasks are being handled efficiently.*

*****Sara**:** Absolutely. Ensuring everything is done correctly is our top priority.*

This conversation demonstrates how Mike and Sara use the passive voice to discuss various actions and processes, focusing on what is being done rather than who is doing it."

'Is Done' in Describing IT Procedures

"In describing standard IT procedures or processes, 'is done' helps in making the process the focus. For instance, 'Backups are done daily.' This emphasizes the regularity and importance of the action, rather than who performs it.

Think about the procedures in your IT work. How do you describe them? Does using the passive voice help in standardizing these processes?"

'Was Done' in IT Project Reporting

"When reporting on completed tasks or projects in IT, 'was done' is often used. It provides a concise way of reporting what has been accomplished. For example, 'The system upgrade was completed last week.' It informs about the completion of the upgrade without focusing on the person or team who completed it.

Reflect on your project reporting. How do you use the passive voice to report on completed actions or projects?"

Enhancing IT Communication with Passive Voice

"In IT, where the emphasis is often on processes, results, and actions rather than the actors, using the passive voice can greatly enhance clarity and focus in communication. It allows you to highlight what was done or is being done, which is often more relevant than who did it.

How do you plan to use the passive voice in your professional communication? In what situations do you find it particularly useful?"

The Importance of Passive Voice in IT Documentation

"In the world of IT, documentation plays a crucial role. How do you describe processes and procedures in your documentation? The passive voice, with 'is done' and 'was done,' is often used to focus on the process rather than who is performing it. For instance, 'The data is processed through several layers of encryption.' This emphasizes the process of encryption, making the documentation more about the action and less about the actor.

When writing technical documents, do you find that using the passive voice helps in making the information more objective and focused on the procedure?"

'Is Done' in Describing Ongoing IT Operations

"In your daily IT operations, how often do you use 'is done' to describe ongoing actions? For example, 'Regular maintenance is done to ensure system stability.' Using the passive voice in such statements shifts the focus to the maintenance work itself, rather than who is carrying it out.

Consider the routine tasks in your IT role. How does the passive voice assist you in emphasizing the tasks rather than the task performers?"

'Was Done' for Reporting Completed IT Tasks

"Reflect on how you report completed tasks in IT. 'Was done' is particularly useful for summarizing completed actions. For instance, 'The software update was completed last night.' This provides a clear statement about the completion of the task without unnecessary details about who did it.

In your experience, how does using the passive voice in reporting help maintain a clear and concise focus on the outcomes?"

Personal Experience: Teaching Passive Voice in IT

"As an English teacher for IT professionals online, I once had a student struggling with report writing. He was unsure whether to use active or passive voice. We worked on a section where he needed to describe a completed project. Using 'was done,' as in 'The system upgrade was completed ahead of schedule,' helped him present the information clearly without focusing on the individuals involved.

Have you encountered similar situations in your IT work where choosing between active and passive voice was challenging? How did you resolve this?"

'Is Done' for Emphasizing Processes in IT Meetings

"Think about the discussions in your IT meetings, especially when explaining how things are done. Using 'is done' can help emphasize the process or the standard practice. 'Backups are done every night at midnight' keeps the focus on the backup schedule rather than who performs it.

How do you typically describe processes in meetings? Do you find the passive voice useful for keeping the focus on the procedures?"

'Was Done' in IT Incident Reports

"When writing incident reports in IT, clarity is key. 'Was done' helps in reporting past actions concisely. 'The system check was done immediately after the incident' gives a clear account of the actions taken, which is crucial in incident reports.

Reflect on your approach to writing incident reports. How does the passive voice help you maintain clarity and focus on the actions taken?"

Enhancing Communication Skills with Passive Voice

"In IT, where communication needs to be clear, concise, and focused, effectively using the passive voice can greatly enhance your ability to convey information about processes and results. It allows you to highlight what was done or is being done, which is often more relevant than who did it.

How do you plan to use the passive voice in your professional communication? Are there specific situations where you find it particularly effective?"

Applying Passive Voice in Real-World IT Scenarios

"Applying the passive voice in real-world IT scenarios is crucial for effective communication, especially in documentation, reporting, and explaining procedures. Whether you're describing an ongoing process, summarizing completed tasks, or writing technical documents, using 'is done' and 'was done' can significantly enhance the clarity and focus of your communication.

In your day-to-day IT tasks, how will you apply what you've learned about the passive voice? How can it enhance your ability to communicate effectively in various professional contexts?"

